

JAVED AKHTAR AND SHABANA AZMI

63 AND 57, ARTISTES (18)

THE COUPLET

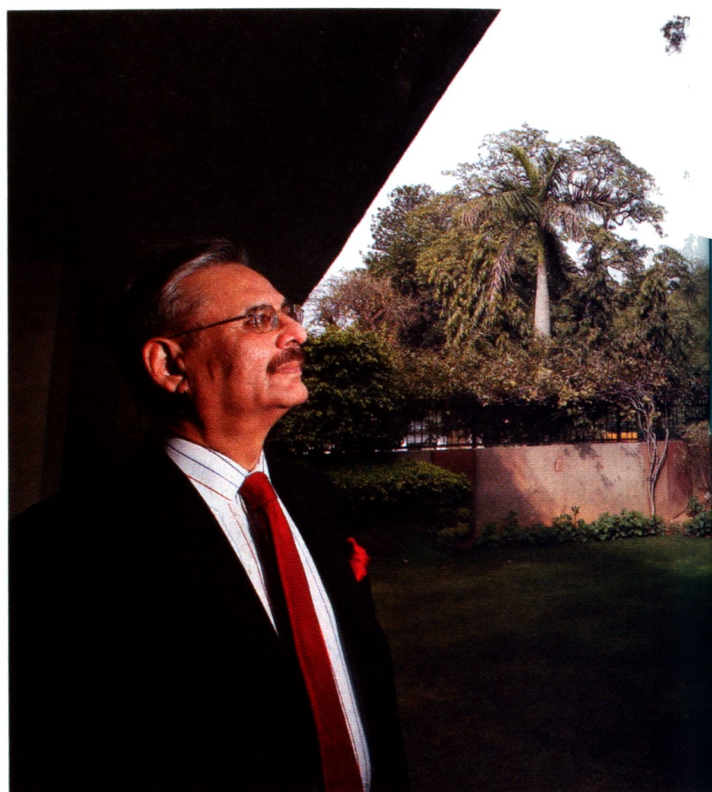
BECAUSE they are not afraid of speaking their mind against what they think is wrong. Because in spite of frenetically busy schedules, they follow it up with action. Because her organisation Nivara Hakk just completed the first phase of building 12,000 tenements for slum dwellers in Mumbai. Because he followed up a speech in Ireland at Amnesty International on Islamophobia in the West with a *pin* against Narendra Modi. Because they are at the top of their craft, she still capable of sizzling on screen with a Zeenat Aman rendition in *Loins of Punjab* and he writing pop poetry for films as diverse as *Om Shanti Om* and *Jodhaa Akbar*.

FOOD FAD: While Azmi's diet yo-yos according to the requirements of the character she plays, Akhtar loves his brown rice, chicken curry and vanilla ice-cream.

TIME OFF: She thinks

ironing clothes is the biggest source of relaxation. He listens to old Hindi film songs.

BIG ACQUISITION: A plot of land in Khandala, where the couple is building their dream home.



Y.C. DEVESHWAR

61, BUSINESS EXECUTIVE (38)

GREEN GIANT

BECAUSE he has seen the future and its colour is green. Because under ITC's social and farm forestry programme, it has provided over 28 million mandays of employment to the disadvantaged. Because the company recycles over 90 per cent of its solid waste every year. Because it is the only company in India to have presented its 2006 sustainability report under the global reporting initiative. Because over half of ITC's over Rs 12,000-crore turnover now comes from its non-cigarette portfolio. Because under its e-choupal initiative, the company has empowered 3.5 million farmers in 38,500 villages. Because it measures its achievements not only by financial performance but also by the transformation it has brought about in enhancing the 'natural and social capital' of the nation.

EVIDENCE OF OBSESSIVE BEHAVIOUR: Sending SMSes at 4 a.m. to group CEOs to check on progress.

IS EMBARRASSED ABOUT: Not always living up to his nickname—Yogi.

THORN IN HIS SIDE: When he took over, they said he inherited a "crown of thorns". Twelve years later, the thorns have given way to a bouquet of new FMCG businesses.

STRANGE BUT TRUE: Does not have an e-mail id.

